

Phishing Awareness Guide

A cybersecurity project

 Purpose: To understand and prevent phishing attacks

Introduction

In today's digital world, cybersecurity is important because most people use online banking, social media and e-mail services.

Phishing is a common form of cyber attack used for stealing personal information.

This guide provides a simple explanation of phishing attacks, along with real-life examples and prevention techniques.

What is phishing?

Phishing is a type of cyber attack where attackers pretend to be trusted organizations to steal sensitive information like passwords, OTPs, or bank details.

Example: You receive an email saying:

“Your bank account will be blocked in 24 hours. [Click here to verify immediately.](#)”

The link leads to a fake website that steals your login details.

Types of Phishing

1. Email phishing  : In this you get fake emails.

2. SMS Phishing(Smishing): In this you get fake SMS

Example :

“ You have won a lottery of 50,000. [Click here to claim.](#)”

3. Fake Website Phishing

In this, you get fake websites in which you are asked to enter the password of your user account and that password goes to the hackers.

4. Voice Phishing: (vishing)

In this they call you and ask for OTP.

Example

“Hello, I am calling from the SBI. I want to KYC your account. Please tell me the OTP.”

5. How to Identify Phishing?

You can identify phishing attempts using these signs:

- Suspicious email address (e.g., support@bank-secure123.com)
- Urgent or threatening language
- Fake links (hover shows different URL)
- Asking for OTP or password

Example:

Fake URL: 📌 www.paypa1-login-secure.com
(Notice “1” instead of “l”)



Safety Tips

Never share OTP or password

Always check website URL carefully

Use two-factor authentication

Avoid clicking unknown links

Verify messages directly from official apps

Real-life Scenario:

A user receives a message:

“Your Instagram account has been compromised.
Login immediately to secure it.”

The link leads to a fake login page. If the user enters credentials, attackers gain full access to the account.

Cybersecurity Mindset

Good cybersecurity is not only about tools but also about awareness. Users should always verify before trusting any online message.

Conclusion

Phishing attacks are becoming more advanced. Awareness and caution are the best defense against cyber threats.

Thankyou

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